Notices in Business Correspondence

SECTION 1: UNDERSTANDING NOTICES

What is a Notice?

A notice is a brief written or printed announcement used to inform a large group of people. It gives specific information about an upcoming event, meeting, rule, or decision. Notices are usually displayed on notice boards or sent to members officially.

Purpose of a Notice

- Announce events or meetings
- Warn or inform employees
- Give official statements
- Create a legal/official record

Importance of Notices in Organizations

- Notices keep employees and students updated about upcoming events or policy changes.
- They create a written record that can be checked later.
- Because notices are formal, they help maintain discipline and transparency in a workplace or educational setting.

When Are Notices Used?

- Notices are used when information needs to reach many people quickly.
- They are commonly issued for meetings, deadlines, exams, warnings, holidays, emergency announcements, and organizational decisions.

SECTION 2: FORMAT & STRUCTURE OF A NOTICE

Structure of a Notice

- Name of organization
- Title (NOTICE)
- Date
- Subject line
- Body (details)
- Signature, name & designation

Explanation

- The **name of the organization** shows where the notice is coming from.
- The **title** clearly identifies the document as a notice
- The **date** shows when the announcement was issued and helps in record-keeping.
- The **subject line** tells the main topic in one sentence.
- The **body** gives details like time, date, venue, and purpose.
- The **signature or designation** shows who is responsible for the information in the notice.

Language Used in Notices

- Notices are written in formal and simple language.
- The sentences are short and direct.
- They avoid unnecessary explanation.
- They are often written in active voice.
- The tone is neutral, and the focus is only on the important information.

Layout Guidelines

- A notice should look clean and easy to read.
- It should have proper spacing and a clear structure.
- Important details like the date, time, and venue are usually highlighted.
- Use bullet points

SECTION 3: TYPES OF NOTICES

Meeting Notice

- A meeting notice informs members about the date, time, and place of a meeting.
- It may also include the agenda or mention that the agenda will be shared separately.
- Meeting notices must be sent early to ensure everyone attends.

Example of Meeting Notice

XYZ Company Ltd.

Notice of Meeting

Date: November 25, 20xx

Time: 10:00 AM
Venue: Conference Room A, XYZ Company Ltd.

Subject: Monthly Sales Review Meeting

All department heads are requested to attend the monthly sales review meeting. Please bring the sales reports and performance analysis.
Issued by: Rahim Khan

Company Secretary

Event Notice

- Event notices are issued when an organization is planning a seminar, competition, workshop, or celebration.
- These notices provide all necessary details such as purpose, schedule, and participation instructions.

Example of Event Notice

Global Tech Club

Event Notice

Date: November 28, 2025

Time: 3:00 PM
Venue: Auditorium, Global Tech Club Event:

Annual Tech Innovations Seminar

All members are invited to attend the seminar featuring talks by industry experts. Your participation is highly encouraged.
Issued by:

Hina Riaz

Event Coordinator

Warning Notice

- A warning notice is given when someone breaks rules or does not follow proper behavior.
- It is written formally and explains what the mistake was, along with the consequences if the behavior continues.

Example of Warning Notice

ABC Enterprises

Warning Notice

Date: November 20, 20xx

To: Mr. Ali Shah

Position: Customer Support Executive

This notice is issued due to repeated delays in submitting customer reports. Please consider this a formal warning. Any further delays may result in disciplinary action.

Issued by:

Sana Malik HR

Manager

Public Notice

- Public notices are meant for the general public.
- They are usually issued by authorities for matters like lost-and-found items, property ownership changes, or important public announcements.

Example of public Notice

City Council, Karachi

Public Notice

Date: November 20, 2025

Notice is hereby given that the construction of the new public library on Main Street will commence from December 1, 2025. Residents are requested to avoid the area during construction hours.

For more information,

contact: 021-1234567

Issued by:

City Planning Department

Administrative Notice

- Administrative notices are issued by the management to give instructions or share decisions.
- These could include changes in office timings, new policies, or important directions that employees must follow.

Example of Administrative Notice

ABC School

Administrative Notice

Date: November 20, 2025

To: All Teachers and Staff

Please submit the annual performance appraisal forms to the HR department by November 30, 2025. Late submissions will not be accepted.

Issued by:

HR Department

Emergency Notice

- Emergency notices are sudden and urgent announcements.
- They may inform people about unexpected holidays, safety issues, urgent meetings, or immediate actions required due to an emergency.

Example of Emergency Notice

City Hospital

Emergency Notice

Date: November 20, 2025

Attention: All Staff and Patients

The main hospital entrance is closed today due to pipe damage. Please use the side entrance until further notice.

Issued by:

Administration Office

SECTION 4: GUIDELINES & MISTAKES

Do’s & Don’ts of Notice Writing

Dos of Notice Writing

- Be specific
- Keep tone official
- Add clear details (date, time, venue)
- Use bullet points
- Stick to the topic

Don’ts of Notice Writing

- No slang or informal language
- No personal comments
- Don’t write long stories
- Don’t leave out important information
- Don’t exaggerate

How to Avoid Mistakes in Notices

- Follow a proper format.
- Proofread before finalising.
- Use clear and simple wording.
- Focus only on relevant information.
- Always double-check the date, time, and spelling of names.